Daniel (Haofan) Cai

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University **Evanston, IL**
B.A. in Data Science & Economics | Minor in Statistics Expected June 2028

EXPERIENCE

CalPriceIQ **Boise, ID**
Data Science Intern/ Cohort Leader @ IDXExchange June – September 2026

- Built XGBoost close-price model on 397K+ California MLS listings extracted and cleaned via SQL (R^2=0.90, MAPE=11.75%)
- Designed temporal train/test split (most-recent-month holdout) to prevent look-ahead leakage in time-series housing data
- Engineered preprocessing across 82 features: median/mode imputation, one-hot and ordinal categorical encoding, amenity text parsing into binary indicators, log-transform of skewed price/area variables, and dropping 15+ columns with >80% missingness
- Diagnosed ListPrice as a leakage feature via feature-importance analysis; removal preserved inference for off-market properties
- Located over/under-prediction segments by evaluating MAPE/MdAPE across price bands on ~30K held-out listings

GridGate LLC **Evanston, IL**
Co-Founder, Lead Data Scientist (De-Risking & Queue Projection Team) January – June 2026

- Flagged risk interconnection-queue withdrawals (AUC up to 0.84) by developing logistic regression and random forest models
- Built web scrapers to continuously monitor 1,000+ policy-related sites, running sentiment analysis on 500+ articles to surface early signals on interconnection-relevant policy shifts that fed into the team's risk-scoring framework
- Engineered operational risk features (queue congestion, stage timing patterns, MW revisions) to improve dropout separability
- Built cost-projection models to forecast interconnection costs, projecting ~$500k savings per project

Fantuan Delivery *(Series C, $90M+ raised; food delivery platform across North America, UK & Australia)* **Toronto, Canada**
Operations and Strategy Intern April – July 2026

- Contributed to a successful Tencent partnership for global meal plans and delivery-partner integration by building market sizing and 4 KPI projections (GMV, orders, partner coverage, engaged users) across 3 metro markets
- Sized a CA-to-Chicago market-entry plan across 3 metro regions via TAM-SAM-SOM, targeting 2027 nationwide coverage
- Designing 20-question surveys across 5,000+ users and analyzing in-app interaction data to propose English UI/UX changes
- Designed A/B test for English UI redesign: defined order-conversion as primary metric, ran power analysis (~6.4K users/arm for 10% MDE), and specified 2-week rollout across 3 markets

Zenitera Funds Co. **Remote/Shanghai, China**
Data Science and ML Development Intern November 2025 – March 2026

- Built an LLM contract-review agent that segments contracts into clauses, classifies them against a 28-category taxonomy (17 regulatory + 11 company-specific), and auto-generates Word comment bubbles flagging risks for legal team review
- Engineered a 4-stage Python pipeline (docx XML parsing→ clause segmentation→ classification→ risk prediction) parsing 320 contract clauses at 100% text coverage; fixed parser bugs recovering 90% lost reviewer comments from test set
- Induced 34 review patterns from 62 human-redlined clauses across 139 official checklist items, replacing an 8-rule playbook
- Designed an eval framework to benchmark Qwen vs. Claude on a 69-block hand-labeled gold set with leave-one-out validation

PROJECTS

BridgeLytic Product OS | *Python, OpenAI API, Grok API* **Remote**
Founding Product Developer September 2026 – Present

- Building an agentic decision-workflow system, including the data model, approval gates, and acceptance criteria
- Interviewed 12 product/ops leaders to map decision bottlenecks and presented findings to the founder ahead of a full v1 review

2026 DSAC Datathon 3rd place | *Python, Postgres SQL, Tableau, XGBoost* **Evanston, IL**
Team Member January 2026

- Applied linear regression and XGBoost to model cheesesteak demand and delivered Tableau dashboards with insights

ACTIVITIES

Data Science and Analytics Club (DSAC) **Evanston, IL**
Outreach & Events Director September 2025 – Present

- Researched, organized speaker events and alumni coffee chats to inform members on Data Science careers and experiences

TAMID Consulting Group **Evanston, IL**
Program Director September 2025 – Present

- Managed intake and progress tracking for 7 projects in Spring 2026, coordinated finance and mentorship across the portfolio

SKILLS / ACTIVITIES

Technical: Python (Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn), MySQL, R, Excel, Strata, Git, Tableau| ML: Decision Trees, Gradient Boosting, K-means, Random Forest, XGBoost | AI/LLM: LLM Pipelines, Prompt Engineering, A/B Testing, Model Eval/Benchmarking, Document Parsing, Propersity Score Match
Membership: Bouldering Club, Intramural Basketball, Phi Kappa Psi, Digital Illustration and Oil Painting, Fighting Game Student Org, CSA